

MASTER THE PLANCHE FROM ZERO TO STRADDLE



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CHAPTER 1 : INTRODUCTION

The Planche, a highly coveted calisthenics skill in the street-workout world, is the epitome of strength and grace.

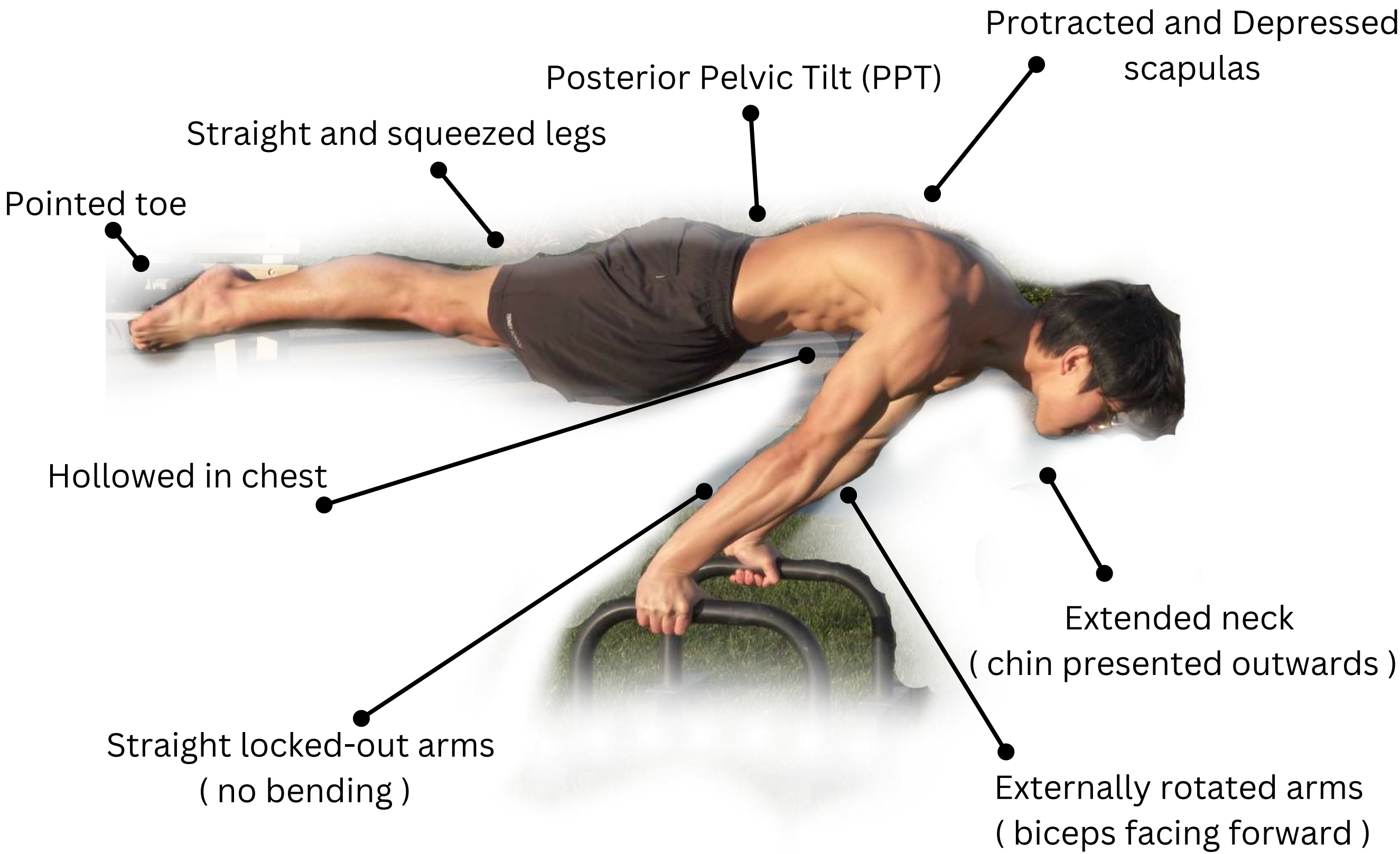
It is a movement that requires significant upper body strength and balance. It involves suspending your body in a horizontal position, parallel to the ground, while supported only by your hands.

CHAPTER 2 : DEFINITION

The Planche is a complex calisthenics skill that can take many forms, and achieving proper execution requires precise technique.

This chapter aims to help you identify and rectify common mistakes, ensuring that your Planche is performed with standard form.

To perform a Planche correctly, pay attention to the following indicators of proper technique.



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CHAPTER 3 : TECHNIQUE

Why is the correct form essential in performing Planche?

It is important to know that Planche is a movement that can cause severe injuries if done incorrectly! Since you are suspending your body in the air, gravity is putting a lot of stress on your muscles and joints as you try to fight against it. Having the correct muscle activation and technique will help you avoid injuries, so be sure to check your form frequently.

Here are some common mistakes that occur while performing Planche along with solutions to correct them.

Common Planche mistakes :

- **Bent arm:** Arms are not locked

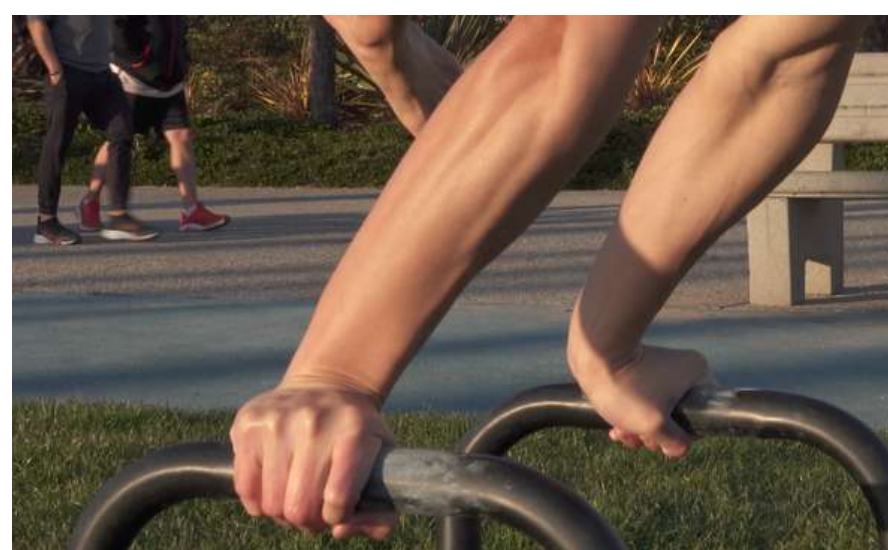
How to Fix:

- Flex your triceps to lock out your arms
- Externally rotate the arms

- **Collapsed/Broken wrist:** Wrists are not perpendicularly on top of the bar

How to Fix:

- Position the wrist to be above the bar
- Grip the bar tightly, apply pressure at the back of the palm
- Lean into the wrist but do not compress it too much



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- **Banana Back:** Overuse of the low back.
Not maintaining PPT

How to Fix:

- Use lower back less
- Extend through legs
- Push Hips down (Posterior Pelvic Tilt)
- Maintain core engagement

- **The Mountain/Pike:** Butt is in the air

How to Fix:

- Activate PPT
- Less lift through the lower back
- Squeeze glutes and push down

- **The Winging Depression:** Retraction of scapulas

- How to Fix:
- Protract scapulas
 - Push down through shoulders
 - Hollow the chest (suck the chest in)
 - Keep core engaged

- **Bent Leg:** Unflexed/bent legs

How to Fix:

- Tighten/flex your legs

- **Dead Planche:** overcompensating with lean/overleaning

How to Fix:

- Lean less
- Elevate the rest of the body

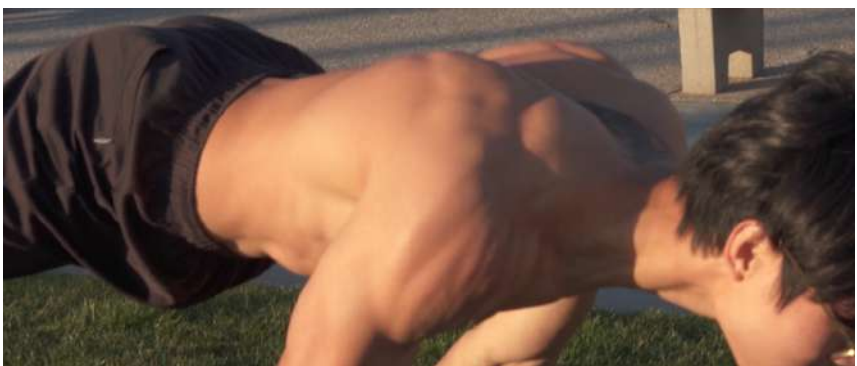


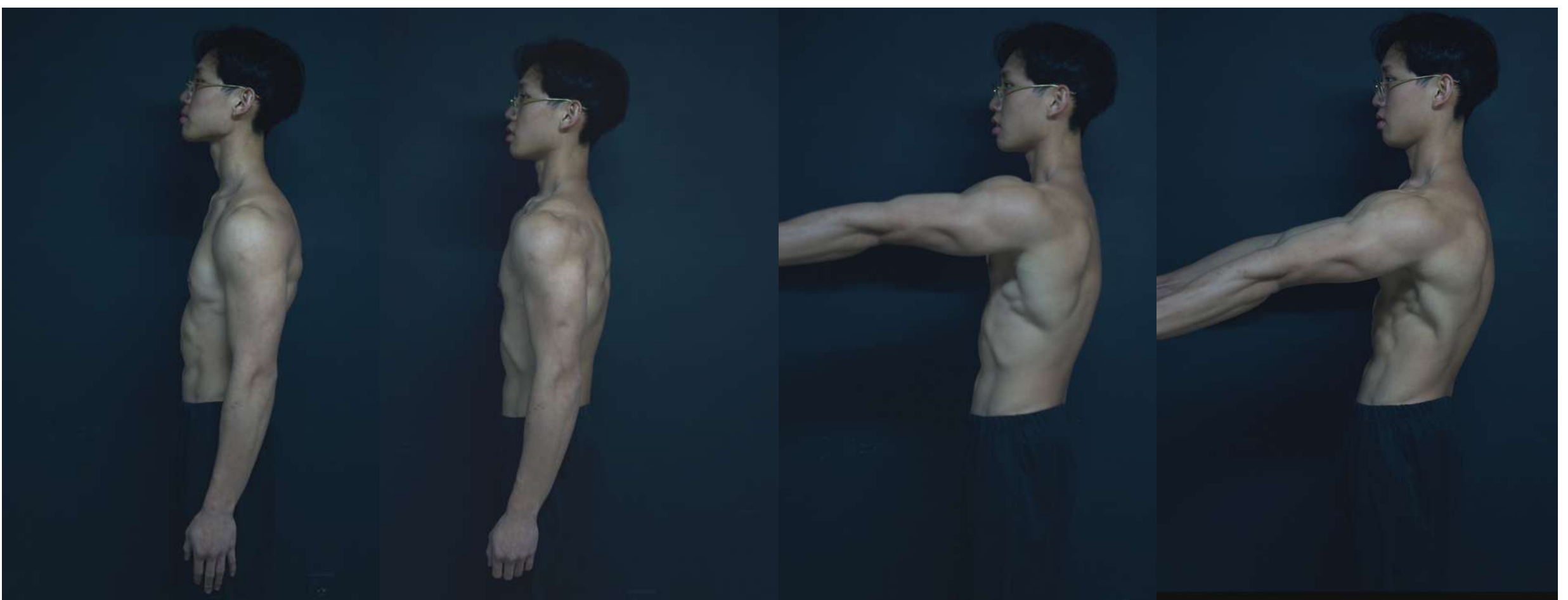
Planche is a skill that is highly technical and requires a deep understanding of the movement to perform it correctly.

Technique and muscle activation are key aspects of Planche. In this chapter we will be breaking down the technicalities and intentional muscle activation you need to do to perform the Planche.

First, let's start with **Technique**

Upper Body Technique :

- Presentation of shoulders is the foundation to build the base to lift your body above the ground. With your arms extended straight out, roll your shoulders forward and externally rotate your arms outwards.
- Next, you would want to protract by spreading your scapula, further stretching your arms outwards, and feeling like you have a rounded back as if you were a turtle.
- Now, maintain that tension you did in steps 1 & 2. With the combined technique of the previous steps, you would want to depress your scapula by squeezing down and feeling the latissimus dorsi (Lats) activated.



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Lower Body Technique :

- The lower body activation is much simpler, start by squeezing your glutes, hamstrings, quads, and calves to create the posterior chain activation.
- Next, keep this posterior tension and thrust your hips forward activating PPT, you should feel tension at your lumbar region, which means the muscles have been activated and you have formed a chain link with the upper body.



Now you understand the technique and muscle activation, time to take this movement to the floor with Planche leans and understand it further.

REMEMBER: focus on proper muscle activation, not the visual aspect. Having intentional muscle activation will lead to a pleasing visual aspect (nice protraction, good alignment, PPT) as a by-product. (Correct Muscle Activation > Visual Aspect)

How to Planche Lean :

Planche leans are the fundamentals for building a solid Planche base. Many people do not get much progress doing this exercise due to poor execution. Here we are going to go through the proper execution of this movement.

1. Start in a push-up position with palms facing 45 degrees outwards.
2. Rotate your arms , ensuring the biceps are facing forward, and lock your elbows.
3. Now focus on scapular protraction by pushing your shoulder blades down.
4. Squeeze your glutes and legs, ensuring lower body activation.
5. Once everything is set, lean forward maintaining correct muscle activation.



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How to Tuck Planche + Advance Tuck :

Tuck Planche is the beginning of your Planche journey and it is the most problematic of all the Planche progression. Under ideal circumstances, you should progress out of Tuck Planche quickly to the Advance Tuck, which is a more effective progression in terms of proper muscle activation. Here we will be discussing the execution of the Tuck Planche into the Advance Tuck.

- Following the steps of doing a Planche lean, get into the proper position where you are able to utilize the maximum muscle activation
- Instead of leaning as far as you can in a lean, you would want to instead slowly slide your legs closer into your chest (essentially bringing your legs into the body) and push out tall to elevate yourself from the ground
- You can also try entering the Tuck Planche from a different way which is starting in a tucked position and simply pushing yourself off the ground



****It is easier when you have elevations to perform this skill, the lower you are to the ground the harder it gets, the higher you are the more room you have to bring yourself up**

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How to Tuck Planche + Advanced Tuck :

Now that you are in a Tuck position, to transition into the Advanced Tuck, simply extend your legs out by driving your knees downwards, tilting your hips and activating PPT



This progression is great because it teaches you how to extend your lower back and learn the correct lower-body muscle activation.

How to Straddle Planche :

The highlight of every Planche beginner's dream, the Straddle Planche will be a journey to achieve and master, so be patient and consistent with your training. Eventually, you will have this skill. Let's explain the 2 most common to enter the Straddle Planche.

1. Starting from a planche lean, in a straddle position, lean and hop or press your body into the straddle planche position.

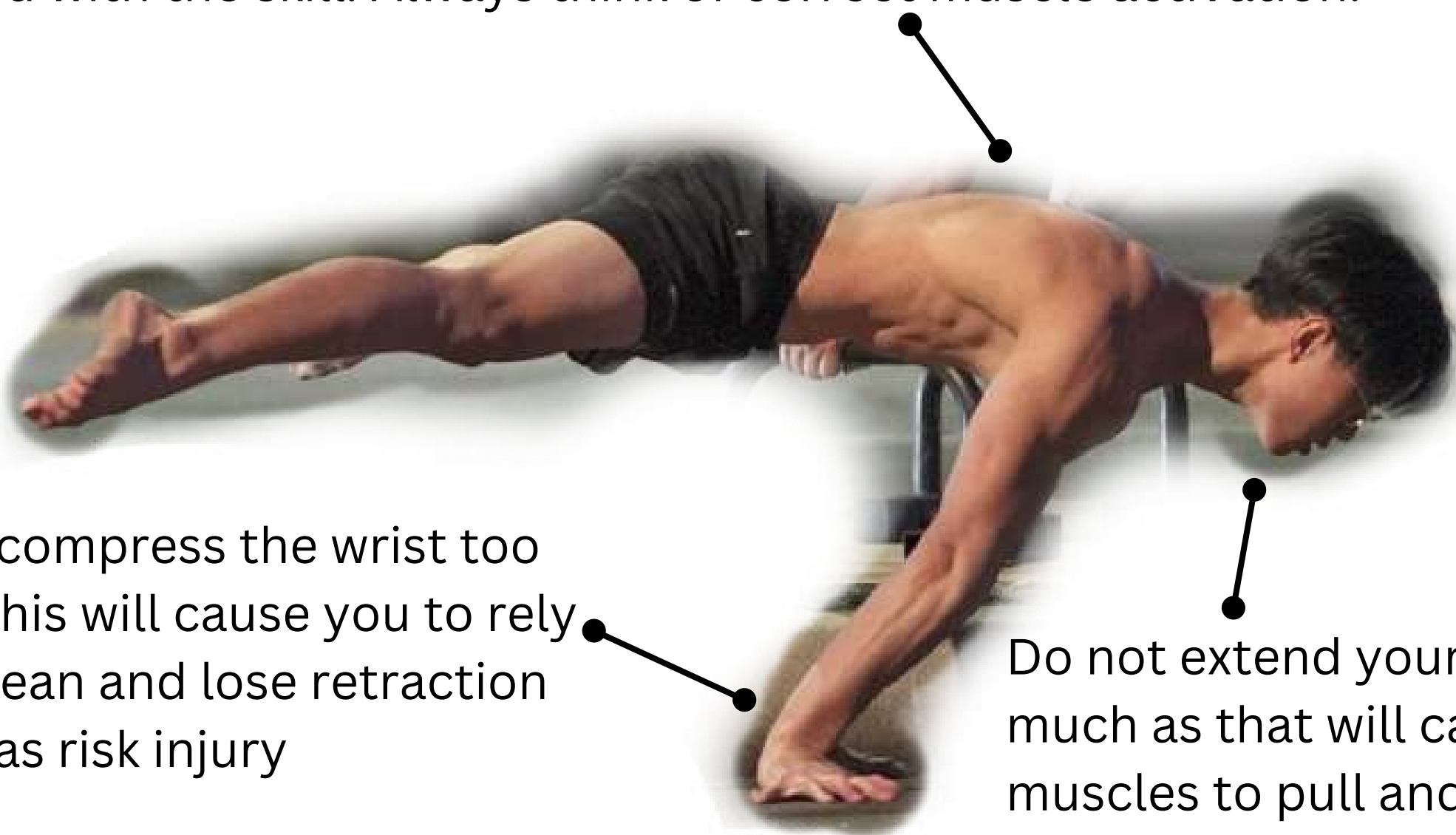
This method will only be possible if you have developed a strong base and proper technique and execution of the Planche Lean.

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2. From a Tuck position and kicking out with your legs and trying to hold that extended position. This method is much easier compared to the first method.



maintain protraction when extending, as long as you do not go into retraction, proceed with the skill. Always think of correct muscle activation.



Do not compress the wrist too much, this will cause you to rely on the lean and lose retraction as well as risk injury

Do not extend your chin out too much as that will cause your neck muscles to pull and work against the protracting muscles which can cause retraction of the scapula

Finally, always film yourself from the side or a 45-degree angle and understand your weak points. Then you can actively work on them to fix the problems you face

CHAPTER 4 : WORKOUT STRUCTURE

Having a proper training structure is very important and is one of the foundations to making good progress in your Planche journey.

Without a proper understanding of how you should structure your training program, people often get frustrated with what they're doing and will not receive any results from it.

In Chapter 3 we will be breaking down how you should plan your training and cover all the important aspects of it.

The training structure is more theoretical rather than practical, so understanding it is important as your training structure can fluctuate and be flexible depending on your goals.

What makes a training program effective?

- Having proper planning that correlates with your goals (Endurance or Strength training)
- Having adequate rest time to recover (The most common mistake people without knowledge do)
- Understanding your priorities (Focusing on 1-2 goals at a time)
- Knowing how to overload yourself (Your body needs new stimuli to adapt and evolve)

1- ENDURANCE OR STRENGTH

It is important to note that depending on the way you train, your body will evolve and adapt to the stimulus that is being put onto it and grow a certain way.

That's why it is highly recommended to know what type of training you are doing.

	Endurance Training	Strength Training
Training structure	- multiple reps in a set (8-15+) or high-volume training - stimulates muscle hypertrophy and leads to greater muscle endurance - better suited for the beginning of your Planche journey because you want a strong base/volume which can allow access to greater intensity/strength.	- low rep range in a set (2-6) low volume training - stimulates strength adaptations since you are applying an intense force that your muscles will need to produce. - better suited further down the Planche journey when you are in the intermediate level
Rest periods	Requires around 1-3 minutes of rest in between sets	Requires around 4-5 minutes of rest in between sets

*Rest periods a very important factor to take in because most people would just rush and do their next set which if your muscles are fatigued, can cause ineffective gains; weaker performance; wasting energy.

The reason behind this is that if your muscles are fatigued from the set you just did, it needs some time to replenish the energy used which is very important in Strength training.

Understanding how long to rest between your sets will help you prolong your energy in your training as well as allow proper stimulus for muscle adaptations.

2- Setting priorities : Setting priorities is very important in skill training. Having your focus spread out in trying to learn multiple different skills at once is ineffective and will not result in much progress.

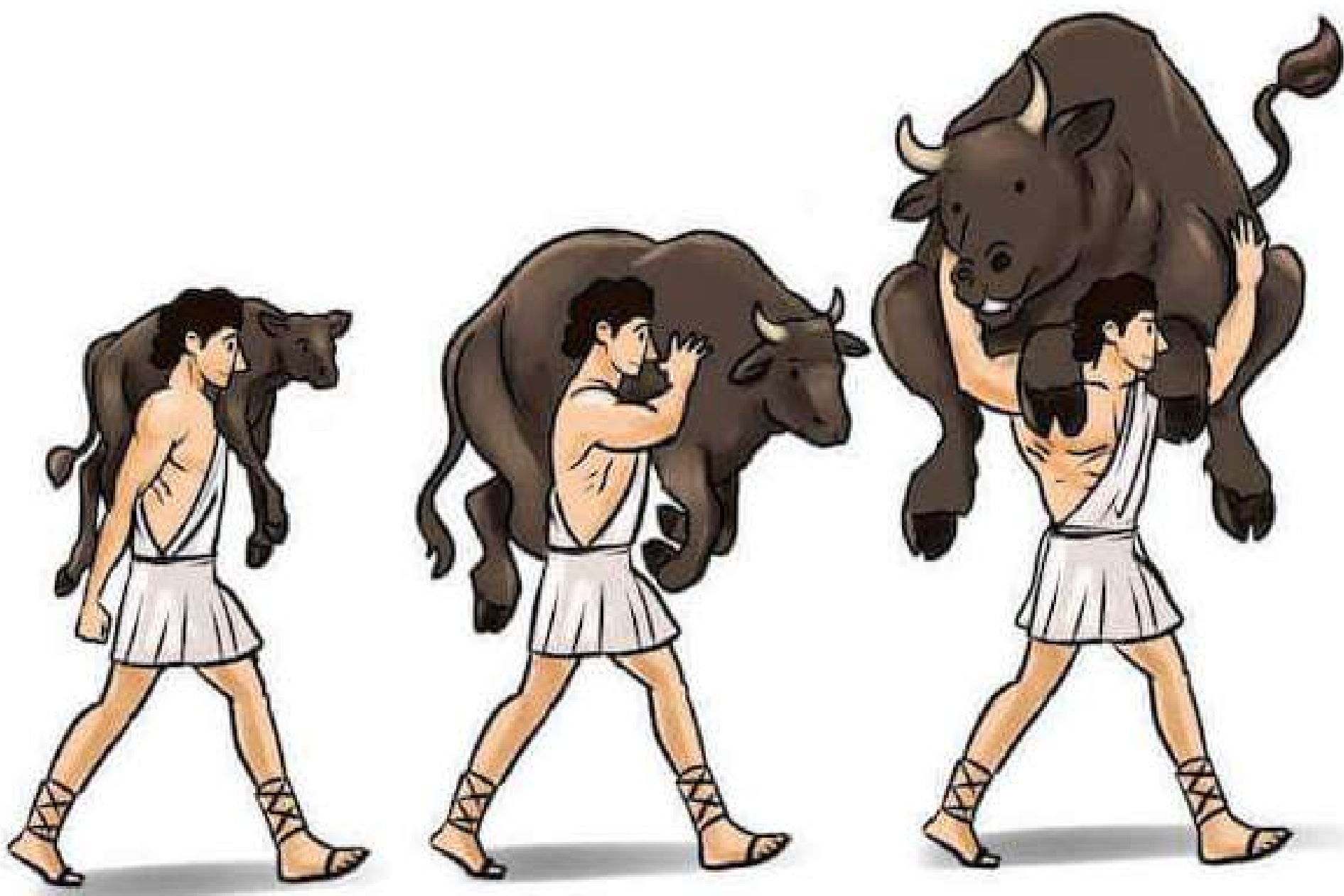
Being specific with your goals is key, it's the same concept as being a Jack-Of-All-Trades and a Specialist, focusing on a single goal and investing all your energy into one goal would allow you to reach it much more effectively and quicker.

If you are focusing on too many skills, you will not be able to progress properly in all the skills you are focused on.

3- Progressive Overload : This is one of the most important concepts to understand because the body is constantly adapting to the new stimuli you are putting on it.

Most people do not understand when the body needs to evolve and adapt to new stimuli so it is always important to test your limits from time to time.

One of the most common mistakes is when people use bands every time they train and never allow a new stimulus (training without bands) to “shock” the body into getting stronger.



Now that you understand what makes a training program effective, we can combine and apply these concepts that were just explained into a proper training program.

The first step is to structure your training program. Are you training for **strength** (to unlock a new skill or make the skills you have more proficient) or **endurance** (to increase your muscle endurance and size to last longer and be less prone to fatigue)?

Once you have chosen the main goal, the next step is to build your program around it with adequate **rest time**.

KEY TRAINING THEORIES :

Priming	Greasing The Groove	Intensity or Volume	Periodization
Strategically structuring your workout to output your best possible performance you will usually perform the best when you are properly warmed up but not burned out, that is when you want to try your hardest sets To prime effectively, start with warm up and activation drills, gradually increase difficulty from 30% to 70% to peak performance over several sets, and rest for 4-5 minutes between each set to avoid fatigue.	Greasing The Groove (GTG) involves high frequency, low intensity attempts outside of normal training sessions. This method increases volume training without exhausting the body. GTG sessions last around 15-20 minutes and should always include a warm-up. GTG helps the body adapt to the Planche position faster by constantly engaging the neural connection.	When training for the Planche, you must choose between intensity and volume. Beginners should focus on volume training to establish a foundation of muscular endurance. Later on, switching between intensity and volume can help achieve different goals. Building volume first is essential to unlock greater intensity and improve form. Form is not the most important aspect for beginners, so focus on building volume.	A highly adaptive training style for maximizing Planche gains. Periodization involves focusing on different periods based on goals, such as form, endurance, and strength. The body requires constant new stimuli to adapt and evolve. Sticking to the same style of training can lead to hitting a plateau. Changing up training style from period to period allows the body to constantly evolve via new stimuli.

CHAPTER 5 : PROGRAMMING

With the explanation given for the various types of training methods and styles, it's time to build your Planche program.

There is no “perfect” Planche program for everyone, so we will provide different exercises based on each individual.

The point of this book is to teach and give you an understanding of how to train for Planche. However, if you just blindly follow a program without understanding the concepts behind it, you will not see results.

There will be a list of exercises you can pick from to build your own program along with a guideline to follow. You are free to choose what exercises suit you best.

Some people might be lacking in protraction strength, some will be lacking shoulder strength and some will not be strong in straight arm movements.

Choosing certain exercises freely will help you work on your own weaknesses. Again as a beginner, the goal is to build volume.

This program guideline will specifically be working on building volume and muscular endurance. Let's begin.

Phase I (Neural Work) :

- Always start off the workout with some basic warm-ups (active dynamic movements) and stretching (mobility work and stretching)
- Then start with the concept of priming and attempt your level of progression in Planche (Tuck, Advance Tuck or Straddle)
- **Burn Outs:** Start at your strongest progression, then switch to the next easier progression, and do this until you reach the easiest progression
- Try to hold the Planche as long as you’re able to with good technique
- Do 1-3 attempts with 10-20 seconds of rest in between each attempts for every set

(1-3 Max Holds of current progression x 4 sets) || 4-5 min of rest

(1-3 Banded Max Holds x 4 sets) || 3-4 min of rest [Only for Straddle Attempts]

Phase II (Dynamic Work) :

- This phase emphasizes dynamic movements of Planche
- Focus more on technique work (maintain correct technique)
- Rest for 3-4 minutes for every set

Lean to Planche Hold (3-6 reps x 3 sets)

- Choose your level of progression to perform this exercise
- Start in planche lean and then slide legs in to a tuck planche position
- Bounce/ Hop off the ground if you are doing straddle planche
- Try to have a mirco-hold when you enter the planche position

Planche Push-ups (3-8 reps x 3 sets)

- Choose your level of progression to perform this exercise
- Focus on pushing on the back of the palm
- Try to regain protraction on the top when you are in the Planche position
- Can choose between spamming (fast reps) or doing it controlled (slow reps)

L-Sit Swing to Planche Hold (5 reps x 3 sets)

- Choose your level of progression to perform this exercise
- Kick out if you are performing the straddle variation
- Use momentum to enter the Planche position but emphasize on controlling it

Phase III (Muscular Work) :

- This is the part where you should be focusing more on building your foundation
- This phase consists of bulky volume work to build endurance and a good base
- You can choose 2-4 exercises in the list below
- Feel free to change up certain exercises to others when you have mastered it
- Rest for 90-180 seconds in between each sets

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Lists of Exercises

- **Planche Leans** (30-60 seconds x 5 sets) **EASY** - focus on holding a good protraction rather than leaning forward



- **Pseudo Planche Push-ups** (6-12 reps x 5 sets) **MEDIUM** - lean more to increase difficulty, focus on protraction at the top of the pushing movement



- **Scapula Push-ups** (10-15 reps x 4 sets) **EASY** - engage in PPT, focus more on sinking and pushing the scapula rather than leaning forward



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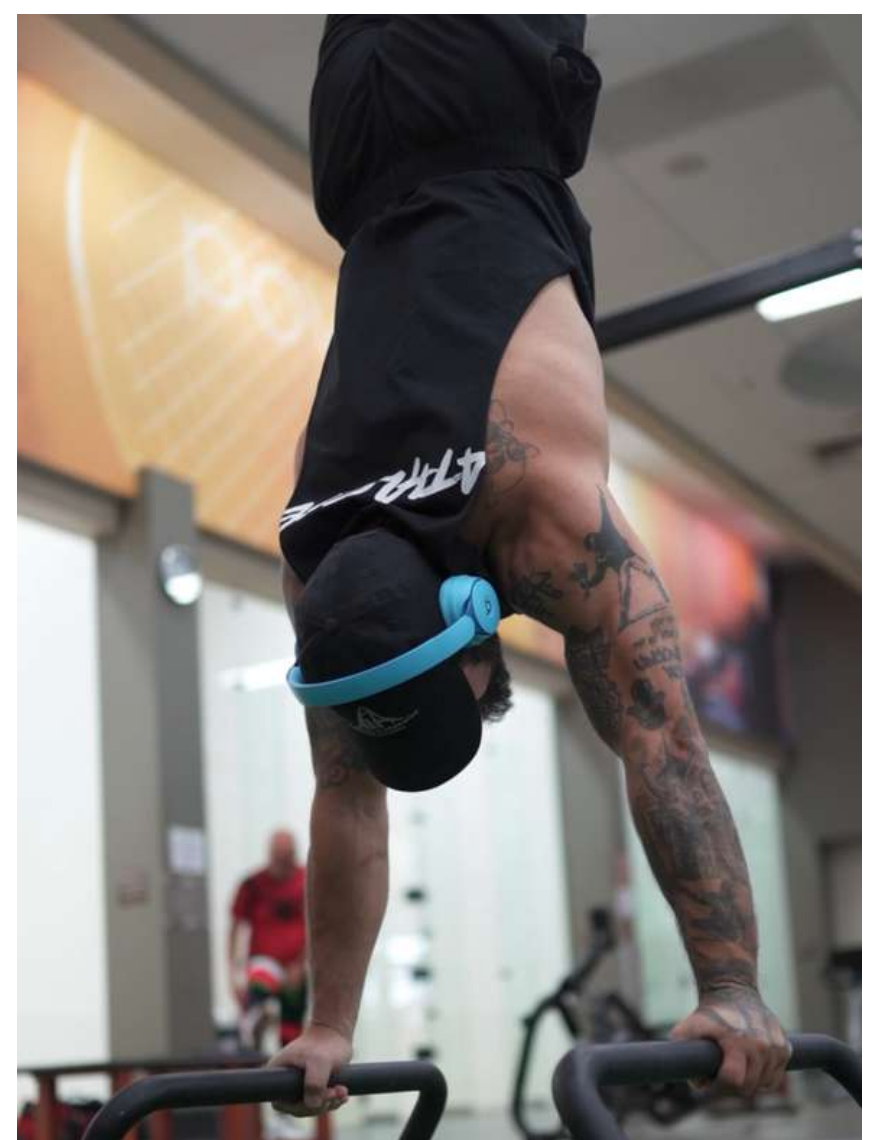
- **Pike to Planche Lean** (8-12 reps x 4 sets) **MEDIUM** - focus on engaging PPT while pushing the hips down, maintain protraction as you lower from pike to lean



- **Hollow-Body Holds** (Max hold x 5 sets) **EASY** - focus on core and hips engagement, increasing difficulty by spreading your arms to the side, as you go wider it gets harder, having your arms over your head is the hardest progression



- **Handstand Push-ups** (4-8 reps x 3 sets) **MEDIUM** - can be done against the wall or freestanding, good for building shoulder strength



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- **90 Degree Bent Arm Hold** (Max hold x 3 sets) **HARD** - focus on keeping the arms bent in a 90 degree angle, keep the core and glutes tight to elevate yourself



Side note: Certain exercises can be done with your feet on an elevated surface, this mimics the Planche position better which allows better understanding of proprioception and increased difficulties. Only do it if you have mastered the exercise.

WEEKLY PROGRAMMING :

Now that you have the guidelines on building your Planche program, here is the training frequency within a week :

A week of training would consist of 2-4 heavy days (Phase I-III) and 2-3 days of active rest days (Phase III only).

These days can fluctuate depending on how your body is feeling so listen to your body and judge your training volume.

Do not go for less than 4 days of training a week or else progress will be minimal.

Do include at least one full rest day where you relax and allow your body to recover.

Here’s an example of a 5-day training week

MONDAY	HEAVY
TUESDAY	HEAVY
WEDNESDAY	ACTIVE
THRUSDAY	REST
FRIDAY	HEAVY
SATURDAY	ACTIVE
SUNDAY	REST

Here’s an example of a 4-day training week

MONDAY	HEAVY
TUESDAY	HEAVY
WEDNESDAY	REST
THRUSDAY	HEAVY
FRIDAY	ACTIVE
SATURDAY	REST
SUNDAY	REST

CHAPTER 6: MINDSET & INJURIES

MINDSET

This is by far one of the most important lessons this book has to offer. Mindset will go a long way in your Planche journey so it is very important to set the right attitude.

There will be many ups and downs in your journey so be patient and stay consistent with your work. Trust The Process, you will be rewarded for your hard work at the end of the day. Winners do what Losers don't want to, always remember that.

Intentionality :

This is a very important factor to consider during every training session. Discipline and Motivation are part of this aspect but these things can only take you so far and will fade from time to time. Having the correct intentionality will bring your training to the next level.

A person that has the intention to train will always outperform someone who doesn't have an intention. This is because if you are determined about doing something with the right intention, your body will emphasize more on the mind-to-muscle connection which allows you to push your body past its limits even on the bad days. If you don't have any intention during training, all it takes is a bad day to give yourself an excuse to not train. You want to keep pushing through, even on the hard days.

Marathon vs Sprint :

Learning Planche or any calisthenics skills takes time, don't expect to get it within weeks when you start learning the skills. This is because bodyweight skills require more neural adaptation (which takes a long time to adapt) compared to muscular adaptation. Training for skills should be approached smartly and patiently. If you want to be efficient, sustainable, and consistent you should think of your training as a marathon. Do not rush your training as if it is a sprint. That would only cause injuries and overtraining which are major setbacks for many athletes.

Grateful Not Satisfied :

Practicing gratuity goes a long way in training. Acknowledge your accomplishments as you progress further into your Planche journey. I recommend you to always film yourself whenever you're training and keep clips of yourself accomplishing new PRs or failures sometimes. After a few months, look back at where you were and compare it to your progress now. If you are dissatisfied with certain things and actively make improvements on those weaknesses. Use that as motivation to constantly push yourself. Always strive to better yourself and keep moving forward.

Consistency & Patience :

The reason why most athletes don't make or see any progress is because of the lack of consistency and patience. Being consistent is something not everyone can do. If you are not consistent you cannot expect to be at the same level as you have been before. The best examples of people being consistent are those who are at the top. Through years of staying consistent with their work, they eventually perfected their craft. Patience is trusting and believing in yourself. People give up when they don't see results after some time. But if you are patient with your work, being consistent by showing up every day, I promise you that you will see progress.

Strategizing :

This is all about literal planning. What happens when you don't see yourself progress? Could it be that something you're doing is wrong? When things aren't right, always take a step back to analyze your approach and re-strategize. Could it be that you are not focusing on your weaknesses? Could it be that you have not switched up your style of training when you hit a plateau? Understand your position and use the knowledge you have learned and create a strategy that works for you to achieve your goals. A good plan will help you train more effectively, work more efficiently and safely as well as produce results faster.

How to deal with Injuries

DISCLAIMER: We are not doctors. We speak based on experience and the knowledge we know.

Most Common Forms of Injuries

1. Thumb (Ligament)
2. Wrist (Ligament)
3. Elbow/Forearm (Ligament or Muscle)
4. Bicep (Tendon)
5. Shoulder (Ligament)
6. Scapula (Muscle)
7. Sub-Scapula (Muscle)
8. Groin/Hip Flexors (Muscle)

Understanding Injuries

Understanding what types of tissue are injured is key to proper recovery.

The above list is the most common form of injuries (for Planche) and what tissue it mostly stems from.

However, keep in mind that it might not always be the case. You should also keep in mind the types of injuries you could be experiencing in order to deal with them better.

Lack of recovery can cause muscle strains (muscular) and sprains (ligaments) which can further worsen into a tear if not treated properly. You'd definitely do not want to experience a tear!

Reasons for Injuries

- **Lack of warmup** - Warmups are important as they direct blood flow into the regions you are working on. Lack of blood flow in those areas would cause the muscles, ligaments, or tendons to be stiff and lose their elasticity. This can easily cause those tissues to be sprained or strained.
- **Lack of Conditioning** - If your tissues are not adapted to the force or pressure you are applying on them, do not force yourself to push through. You would want to take a step back and focus on the basics to condition your tissues to handle the load. If you do not condition yourself, several issues can occur which we'll discuss on the next reason.
- **Overcompensation** - This happens when your body is not conditioned to handle a certain load, overcompensation can occur which will lead to serious injuries. A great example would be someone that does not have good protraction attempts to perform the Planche. In order to still perform the movement, the body will compensate by leaning more and applying strenuous unnecessary pressure on the biceps and wrist. There are many forms of overcompensation so if you are not using the right technique when performing a movement, take a step back and evaluate the problem and begin conditioning.
- **Overtraining** - This happens when the body has been working too hard for an extended period of time with little to no rest given to allow the body to recover. Overtraining is a very common mistake many beginner athletes make. Even if you don't feel sore or tired the next day, allow your body to rest when you have done a proper training session. This can happen on both the muscular and neural aspects so we highly advise you to listen to your body.

Injury Prevention

- **Warm up** - It's as simple as that, always warm up before attempting anything. You always want to optimize the body into an active state before trying out anything that causes tension.
- **Volume over Intensity** - You don't want to always give it a 100% in all your training sessions. That will just lead to overtraining and cause unnecessary fatigue as well as hindering your progress.
- **Listen to your Body** - NO PAIN NO GAIN, that to me is a load of crap. Your body is a vessel that should be respected. If you ever feel discomfort or pain when doing a movement, stop and allow your body to rest. If your muscles are feeling tight, warm up more and stretch them, don't try to push through the pain because you'll only suffer the consequences in the end. Always give your body adequate rest when you feel tired, it's fine to skip a day or two if you are not feeling well.

Injury Recovery

The two main types of injuries can be categorized into :

TYPE OF INJURY	ACUTE INJURIES	CHRONIC INJURIES
Definition	Short and rapid injuries that happen suddenly, painful and sharp	Long lasting injuries that accumulate over time, deep & dull aches
How to treat	RICE modality : Rest, Ice, Compress, Elevate	Heat Therapy : helps relax and loosen the tissue, stimulates blood flow and promote cells to heal the area Massage : reduces tension, causes the muscles to relax, can improve blood flow into the massaged area.

In conclusion, learning the straddle planche is a challenging yet rewarding journey that requires patience, dedication, and consistent practice. By following the step-by-step guide outlined in this ebook, beginners can learn the proper technique and progressions necessary to achieve the straddle planche.

Remember that progress takes time, and it's important to listen to your body and take breaks when needed. Celebrate your small successes along the way, and don't give up even if progress seems slow.

By mastering the straddle planche, you'll not only develop impressive strength and control in your upper body and core, but you'll also gain a sense of accomplishment and confidence in your abilities. Keep pushing yourself and have fun with the process. With hard work and determination, you'll be able to achieve your goals and unlock your full potential as a planche athlete.

We would like to take a moment to express our gratitude for choosing this ebook to guide you in your journey to mastering the straddle planche. It has been a pleasure to share our knowledge and passion for this challenging exercise with you, and hope that this guide has been helpful in your progress.

Thank you for trusting in our expertise, we wish you all the best in your continued practice and growth as a planche athlete.